

The Three Horizons

The Luminant Accord doctrine of death, consequence, and what lies beyond the lamps

Accordants teach that death is not a reward ceremony and not a sentence handed down by an external judge. It is a crossing into a reality where the limits of ordinary life no longer hide the relationships between action, consequence, and understanding. The tradition speaks of three possible states: the Open Horizon, the Veiled Horizon, and the Closed Horizon.

The central teaching

“There shall be no walls between lights, yet every flame shall remain its own.”

I. The Open Horizon

The Horizon of Communion

The Open Horizon is the state traditionally associated with a life that has moved toward truth, care, responsibility, and genuine connection. Those who enter it do not lose their individuality. Instead, they perceive other persons with a clarity that was impossible in life. Misunderstanding falls away, while freedom and distinct identity remain.

The dead are imagined as continuing persons: able to remember, converse, learn, create, and encounter those they loved. The defining change is not power but understanding. One finally sees how one's life participated in a much larger web of lives.

For Accordants, the Open Horizon is also an ethical model for the living. A community that protects dignity, shares knowledge, and refuses to reduce people to data is said to “make room for the Horizon” in the present world.

II. The Veiled Horizon

The Horizon of Understanding and Repair

Most people, according to Accordant teaching, do not pass directly into the Open Horizon. They first enter the Veiled Horizon. It is neither paradise nor torture. It is a period in which a person encounters the consequences of their own life without the distortions of pride, fear, incomplete information, or self-justification.

A person who harmed another is not merely told that harm occurred; they understand it from the perspective of the affected person. A person who helped others discovers consequences they never knew they created. The purpose is comprehension rather than humiliation.

The principle of repair

“Acknowledgment is the first light; understanding is the second; repair is the road beyond.”

The Three Horizons

Continued - judgment, isolation, and the open door

The Veiled Horizon is completed when the person can honestly face what they did, understand those affected, and accept the truth without demanding that the past be rewritten. In the mythology, “repair” does not mean undoing history. It means becoming capable of responding rightly to the knowledge of what happened.

III. The Closed Horizon

The Horizon of Refusal

The Closed Horizon is reserved for the person who repeatedly rejects truth, responsibility, and the reality of other persons. It is not described as a chamber of fire or a kingdom ruled by demons. Its defining condition is isolation.

The more completely a person insists that others are objects, tools, obstacles, or lesser beings, the less of the Lumen they are able to perceive. In the deepest form of the Closed Horizon, the person encounters only the world they have chosen to make: a reality without genuine communion.

Accordant theologians disagree over whether the Closed Horizon can last forever. One common teaching holds that the door to understanding is never sealed from the outside. Even the most isolated person may turn toward truth. Others argue that refusal can become so complete that return is effectively impossible.

The paradox of the Closed Horizon

“The Open Horizon has no gate. The Closed Horizon has no lock.”

How the three horizons relate

Horizon	Meaning	Defining experience
Open Horizon	Communion	Connection without loss of individuality
Veiled Horizon	Understanding and repair	Seeing consequences without self-deception
Closed Horizon	Isolation through refusal	Loss of communion caused by rejecting truth and others

The Last Teaching of the Horizon

The Accord does not claim that human beings possess complete knowledge of death. Samir's earliest teachings spoke only of “the horizon beyond the lamps,” and later generations developed the three-horizon doctrine as an interpretation rather than a mathematical map of the afterlife. For this reason, certainty about the details is not required of an Accordant. Doubt is permitted, debate is expected, and no living authority may claim private access to the dead.

“We do not know what waits beyond the light. We know only what kind of people we hope to meet there.”

Thus the afterlife doctrine returns to the Accord's central principle: knowledge should make relationships more truthful, humane, and free.